

StoryBrand Framework

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Make the customer the hero

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The StoryBrand Framework structures brand messaging as a story in which the customer is the hero, the brand is the guide, and a clear plan leads to success and away from failure.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Developed by Donald Miller in Building a StoryBrand (2017), applying narrative structure to marketing.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to cut through unclear messaging by casting the customer, not the brand, as the hero of the story.

FIGURE 1 · STORYBRAND FRAMEWORK

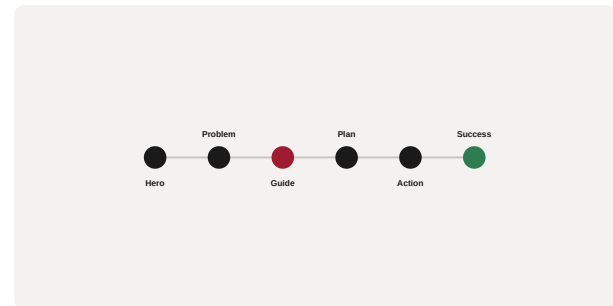


Figure 1. A schematic of the StoryBrand Framework as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Messaging is rebuilt around the seven-part story structure, with the brand positioned as the guide offering a plan.

WHEN IT IS USED

During brand messaging, repositioning and rebranding.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Marketing and brand teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It makes the customer the hero — a discipline that clarifies messaging and resists brand self-absorption.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Miller, D. (2017) Building a StoryBrand. Nashville: HarperCollins Leadership.

Campbell, J. (1949) The Hero with a Thousand Faces. New York: Pantheon.